



**Indian Council for Cultural Relations
(Scholarship Division)**

**GUIDELINES FOR INDIAN MISSIONS/POSTS REGARDING ICCR-SPONSORED
SCHOLARSHIPS FOR FOREIGN STUDENTS**

1. About the admission

Indian Universities/Educational Institutes are autonomous and independent bodies and have their own eligibility criteria. It is, therefore, for the students to satisfy themselves about the course chosen and about the Universities. Decision on admission is **solely** that of the respective University/Institute and queries on this thus should not be directed to ICCR. Admission offered the University/Institute is provisional till the time they satisfy themselves of the authenticity of requisite documents from the students. If on arrival, it is found that the student does not possess the required original documents on the basis/copies of which the admission has been finalized, the students will themselves be responsible for the consequences, including denial of admission by the Universities and student will have to return to his/her country at own cost. ICCR will not bear cost on student's return airfare in such cases. The students while coming to India to join their respective University/Institute should be advised to bring the following documents:

- (i) Original documents relating to their qualifications for verification by the respective college/University.
- (ii) English Translation of the original documents.
- (iii) Certified copy of the syllabus of the last qualifying examination.
- (iv) Valid passport with appropriate visa. Student visa for Undergraduate/Post graduate studies and research visa for Ph.D studies.
- (v) Award of scholarship letter issued by the concerned Indian Mission/post abroad.
- (vi) Undertaking from the student that the course and the University as conveyed is acceptable and that he/she will not request for change at the time of admission.
- (vii) Undertaking from the student that they have read the terms and conditions/ Guidelines of ICCR scholarship as specified in the Scholarship Manual 2024-25, available on ICCR website

The students should be provided contact details of ICCR's Zonal Heads as well as International Student Advisor (ISA) of the University/College for their convenience/facilitation.

2. Pre-departure formalities

(i) Booking of tickets by students:-

(a) The student should request the Indian Mission/Post book the ticket up to (if offered in the scholarship) the airport nearest to the place of university/college where the admission has been confirmed. While booking the ticket, students must ensure that there is sufficient gap between the timings of the connecting flights so that there is enough time to complete the transit formalities, particularly in view of the Covid-19 induced restrictions or regulations. There have been instances when the students have missed their connecting flights due to insufficient layover.

(b) The student should check the allowed baggage regulations. There may be difference of baggage allowance in domestic and international flights. Students must carry the baggage equivalent to the limit of the lower category (domestic/international). In any case, ICCR will not pay any additional amount on account of excess baggage.

(c) Immediately on purchase of ticket, the students should upload their travel details on the A2A portal to enable the relevant ICCR Zonal/Sub Zonal /RP office to make necessary arrangements. Flight details should ideally be conveyed at least 15 days prior to the journey. If airport reception facilitation is not required, students should specifically mention that they do not require any assistance at the airport on arrival.

(d) Students should go through the Covid Protocol/ requirements at all relevant points in their route such as RT-PCR test/quarantine requirements and follow the same to avoid any complications. Mission should advise the students regarding latest Covid-19 regulations in India applicable to them at the time of their travel. All such expenses on Covid-19 including on related tests will not be borne by ICCR.

(e) Students should carry yellow fever/other vaccination certificate wherever necessary.

(ii) Students may be advised to carry with themselves US\$ 700 (at least equivalent to Rs. 50,000/-) to meet immediate expenses. Scholarship expenses will be managed into two parts, which are as follows:-

(A) Hostel dues:- On arrival, all these expenses are to be managed by the scholar.

- i) Hostel fee, Mess fee, Electricity charges, Caution money and Application fee
- ii) Health insurance
- iii) FRRO registration fee/late fee

(B) Stipend/OCF/other dues – After completion of procedural formalities (dues can be released by ICCR but it takes minimum two months time to complete the process).

- i) Stipend, HRA, ACA and thesis charges (to be paid directly to scholar)
- ii) Tuition Fee/OCF (to be paid to university/institute on receipt of demand)
- iii) Air-Tickets (as per admissibility)

(iii) On arrival, students should contact the respective Zonal/Sub Zonal Office of ICCR and get registered with them. Students must also get themselves registered with Foreign Regional Registration Office (FRRO) within a period of 14 days of their arrival in India. This is in addition to contacting the University/Institute being joined. As a good practice, the students should also inform their respective Embassy/diplomatic representative in India about their stay in India on arrival.

(iv) Each visiting student has to procure a medical insurance policy valid in India for a value of Rs. Five lakhs or equivalent. As per the latest ICCR guidelines, medical insurance is **compulsory** for the students (at their cost). Students may buy medical insurance in their country before departure. It is up to the students to select the insurance package. During the ICCR scholarship in India, in case of no medical insurance, ICCR is not liable to bear the medical expenses of the scholar. In case of exigencies, the student should contact his/her respective Embassy/diplomatic representative in India.

(v) Students should carry with them passport size photographs and the joining report form (to be downloaded from A2A portal).

(vi) After admission, the students are advised to stay in University/college hostel. However, in case they choose to stay in private accommodation, they will have to give an undertaking that they themselves are responsible for their security. If they are staying in University/college hostel, they would have to adhere to hostel policies. Failing to observe hostel rules could lead to disciplinary action by University/college.

(vii) The students should ensure that regular half-yearly progress report/results of semester exams along with certificate of attendance issued by Head of Department/ ISA of University/Institute and the valid medical insurance policy are submitted to ICCR Zonal/Sub Zonal/RP Office for smooth release of stipend etc.

(viii) Missions should brief the students that they should keep informed their respective Zonal/Sub Zonal Office about their movement within India. If, leaving for their country/abroad, students must ensure that intimation or permission from Zonal/Sub Zonal/RP Office may be obtained.

- (ix) In case of any mishappening all expenditure on repatriation of student or otherwise will be borne by the student or the family members or their embassy in India. The student should give an undertaking to this effect, duly countersigned by one of the family members and submit to the Indian Embassy/Consulate.
- (x) Mission is requested to kindly ensure the phvsical and mental wellness of scholars before recommending them for awarding of scholarships. This has become necessary due to increasing number of cases of severe home sickness/ psychiatric/ other health issues amongst the incoming foreign students. Such students had to be return to their home country, which is neither good in financial aspects nor for the goodwill of both the lccR and the concerned country. Hence, Mission may take some precautionary measures such as briefing/ counseling of the students, before their final selection/ departure to India.

3. Age limit for availing scholarship

Minimum/Maximum Age limit for students under various courses is as under:-

PhD – 50 Years maximum

UG/PG – 18- 40 Years (18 years as on date 01.07.2024)

There is no upper age limit for courses in Hindi/Sanskrit/Indian performing arts such as Kathak, Bharatnatyam etc

4. No Scholarship for same course

Before issuing Offer Letter to the student, Mission should ensure that student should not be considered for scholarship for the same category of course more than once i.e, in case a student has already availed Scholarship for UG, he/she should not be considered for UG course again. However, such candidate could be considered for award of scholarship for higher course i.e; Post Graduation.

5. Revised guidelines for revival/extension of scholarship

ICCR has discontinued the provision of extension of Scholarship in r/o any student except from Afghanistan who had joined in Academic Year 2021-22 and onwards.

6. Guidelines for Scholarship Schemes (other than Afghan Students) for new students.

In case a new student fails in first year, his/her ICCR Scholarship would be suspended for one - year and he/she would have to self-finance his/her studies. Scholarship may be revived from next year (at the end of 2nd year) provided student clears the first year. In case student fails second time, his/her Scholarship will stand terminated and he/she would have the option to complete his/her course as a self-finance student. In any case, scholarship would not be given for more than the prescribed length of course. Example is given here under:

A new student who joins in July 2024 and onwards:-

Upon declaration of results:

- a) If a student is promoted to the next class, his/her scholarship will continue.
- b) If student fails, and is not promoted to the next class, his/her scholarship will be suspended and can be revived once he/she clears the 1st year (provided he/she clears the exam at the end of 2nd year).
- c) If the student fails again, the scholarship will stand terminated with no recourse for revival.
- d) Scholarship will stand terminated if student fails in 2nd year/any subsequent year and is not promoted in the next class/stage.

- e) Student whose Scholarship is terminated will not be eligible for return air ticket (if the scheme allows air ticket).
- f) The Council will not extend the scholarship period if student is detained/ barred from appearing in the exam due to shortage of attendance or malpractice.

7. Guidelines for Afghan Scholarship Schemes:-

- (i) In case a new student fails and is not promoted to next class in first year, his/her Scholarship may be extended by one year. If the student fails again, and is not promoted to next class, he/she would need to self-finance his/her studies till he/she clears 1st year. Scholarship may be revived from next year (at the end of 2nd year) provided student clears the first year. In case student fails more than twice, his/her scholarship will stand terminated and he/she would have to complete his/her course as a self-finance student. No extension (i.e. scholarship for additional year) be given after completion of 1st Year. In any case, scholarship would not be given for more than the prescribed length of course (plus one year extension).
- (ii) The Council will not extend the scholarship period if student is detained/barred from appearing in the exam due to shortage of attendance or malpractice.
